

✓ CHECK YOUR COMPREHENSION SKILL

Directions (Q.Nos. 1-104) Read the following passages carefully and answer the questions that follow.

PASSAGE 1

As society becomes more and more affluent, people would prefer to work shorter hours at their regular employment so that they may enjoy longer hours of leisure during which they can indulge in more congenial activities. They will not like to waste their leisure time performing routine domestic chores, which tend to sap their energy. The idea of a robot slave which would be capable of performing many of these monotonous chores is one that will appeal to many. Already robots are used in mines and factories to perform tasks which are too risky for human beings. It takes a lot of research by dedicated scientists and sufficient financial backing for a model to be developed to perform a new task. This in turn depends on the number of people who feel the need for a robot to perform these specific tasks.

The problem of designing a robot capable of performing various routine tasks around the house is not insurmountable. A domestic robot slave with its own computer and response mechanism and source of power, which can be programmed to perform certain specific tasks, is not an impossibility.

1. In an affluent society, people prefer to work shorter hours because
 - (a) they are lazy
 - (b) they do not have the strength to work
 - (c) they want time to carry out other activities
 - (d) they abhor their work
2. Domestic chores
 - (a) are welcome by housewives
 - (b) are too demanding
 - (c) lead to family discord
 - (d) are too time consuming
3. Robots are already used in mines and factories to perform
 - (a) hazardous tasks
 - (b) tasks with greater efficiency than human beings
 - (c) tasks which lead to economy in the operations
 - (d) tasks which are forbidden by the labour laws
4. Developing a robot capable of performing a new task
 - (a) is difficult for the scientists
 - (b) is impossible for the scientists
 - (c) requires huge capital
 - (d) depends on the number of people who require it

PASSAGE 2

The energy crisis has been with us for a long time and will be with us even longer. Whether Arab oil flows freely or not, it is clear that the world industry cannot be allowed to depend on so fragile a base. The supply of oil can be shut off at whim any time. In any case, the oil wells will run dry in about 30 years. New sources of energy must be found and this will take time. But it is not likely to restore that sense of copious energy availability we had in the past.

5. In the writer's opinion, the energy crisis
 - (a) is an outcome of unregulated supply of oil to industries
 - (b) will subside as soon as the Arab oil begins to flow again
 - (c) is very likely to lead to the world war
 - (d) will remain with us for an almost indefinite period of time
6. The phrase 'so fragile a base' refers to the
 - (a) current energy crisis in the world
 - (b) uncertainty about the flow of Arab oil
 - (c) delay in finding the new energy sources
 - (d) drying up of the oil wells in future
7. The type of writing in the given passage could be called
 - (a) official
 - (b) scientific
 - (c) popular
 - (d) political

PASSAGE 3

All who have gone before you have submitted to the stroke of death. All who come after you shall undergo the same fate. The great and the good, the prince and the peasant, the renowned and the obscure travel alike the road which leads to the grave.

At the moment when you expire, thousands throughout the world shall with you, be yielding up their breath. Can that be held to be a great calamity which is common to you with everything that lives on the Earth, which is an event as much according to the course of the nature, as it is that leaves shall fall in autumn or that fruit should drop from the tree when it is fully ripe.

8. Death is a natural phenomenon because
 - (a) the moment you die, thousands of people all over the world die with you
 - (b) it is as natural as the fall of leaves or fruits from the trees
 - (c) many people have died in the past
 - (d) the great and the good, the prince and the peasant, the renowned and the obscure, all die

- 9.** The author compares death with the fall of the ripe fruit from a tree to show that death
- (a) occurs in nature also
 - (b) is a kind of fall from a great height
 - (c) gives freedom from the ordeals of life
 - (d) occurs with the achievement of fullness
- 10.** Which one of the following sentences shows that death is a great leveller?
- (a) All who come after you shall undergo the same fate
 - (b) The great and the good, the prince and the peasant, the renowned and the obscure travel alike the road which leads to the grave
 - (c) At the moment when you expire, thousands throughout the world shall with you, be yielding up their breath
 - (d) All who have gone before you have submitted to the stroke of death

PASSAGE 4

I was late bloomer and always envied those people who stood out in high school because I didn't. I learned early on though that it's essential to set yourself apart from the group. Life is one struggle after another to succeed, particularly when you're starting out. If your biodata is sitting at the bottom of a pile of junk mail, sometimes a distinctive approach will get you noticed, especially if the competition is fierce.

Once my partner Jerry and I asked the other freelance writers of a TV serial what characters they hated to write for the most. Everybody said the same thing—they disliked writing for the minor characters because they thought that writing for them wouldn't help them get other jobs. Jerry and I decided that we would write scripts for the minor character because that's what was needed and we needed to set ourselves apart.

In the first script, Jerry and I wrote a school-girl falls in love with a boy in her class. The producers loved the story. And with that one script, Jerry and I were no longer just another comedy-writing team.

- 11.** The author is of the opinion that
- (a) one should be part of the group
 - (b) one should be different from others
 - (c) it is important to do well in high school
 - (d) one should heed to the advice of the seniors
- 12.** Jerry and the author wrote scripts for the minor characters
- (a) to realise their creative potential
 - (b) to earn more money
 - (c) to establish a different image
 - (d) because they did not have enough work

- 13.** According to the author,
- (a) one should be very meticulous in preparing his biodata
 - (b) competition in the job-market is very fierce
 - (c) one should follow a conservative approach in preparing his biodata
 - (d) one should try to get noticed by being innovative
- 14.** The author had been
- (a) into advertising business
 - (b) a comedy writer
 - (c) a music director
 - (d) a news reader

PASSAGE 5

Wind-power has obvious advantage as it is non-polluting, causes no ecological imbalance, requires no throughput fuel and has extremely low gestation period. After almost a decade of sporadic growth, wind energy finally seems to be stepping out from shadows of alternative technology into the commercial mainstream, worldwide.

Even though, India now has an installed base of just over 1600 MW, this is nothing compared to countries such as Germany which meets around 20% of its energy requirements from wind energy. Wind-power offers long-term price stability too. Not only are generation costs of such projects low, the capital expenditure is comparable to fossil fuel based stations. Wind-power plants have low operating and maintenance costs. Long-term economics work out to be quite favourable for the wind energy. Infact, it is being seen as a solution to sustainable development. By the end of 2001, the installed wind-power was almost 25000 MW.

- 15.** Which one of the following statements is correct?
- (a) Wind-power plants take a long time to get commissioned
 - (b) Maintenance cost of wind-power plants is high
 - (c) Wind-power plants lead to violent vibrations
 - (d) Wind-power plants require no fuel
- 16.** Which one of the following statements is correct?
- (a) Installation of wind-power is resisted by environmentalists
 - (b) Generation cost of wind-power plants is high
 - (c) Installation cost of wind-power plants is much higher than of fossil fuel based plants
 - (d) Wind-power is now being commercially harnessed
- 17.** Which one of the following statements is correct?
- (a) In Germany, 25000 MW of electricity is generated by using wind-power
 - (b) Wind-power plants offer no price stability
 - (c) Wind-power is economically viable on long-term basis
 - (d) In America, 20% of the power requirements are met through wind-power

PASSAGE 6

Personally, I have been very fortunate and almost inevitably, I have received courtesy from my own countrymen as well as from the English. Even my goalers and the policemen, from place to place have been kind to me and much of the bitterness of conflict and the sting of goal-life has been toned down because of this human touch. It was not surprising that my own countrymen should treat me so for I had gained a measure of notoriety and popularity among them. Even for Englishmen, I was an individual and not merely one of the mass and I imagine the fact that I had received my education in England, brought me nearer to them.

18. The phrase 'almost inevitably' in this passage means
 (a) without precedence (b) unexpectedly
 (c) invariably (d) considerably
19. The writer is of the opinion that the bitterness of conflict has been toned down because of
 (a) the adversary's courteous behaviour
 (b) the adversary's diplomatic behaviour
 (c) his good behaviour
 (d) the writer being close to the Englishmen
20. The writer's own countrymen treated him with love and regard because of
 (a) a human touch in their nature
 (b) his good political work
 (c) his courage and generosity
 (d) his widespread popularity among the masses

PASSAGE 7

English is generally acknowledged to be the world's most important language. It is perhaps worth trying to understand briefly the basis for that evaluation. There are after all thousands of languages in the world and each seems to be uniquely important to those who speak it as their native language, the language they acquired at their mother's knee. But there are some objective standards to judge their relative importance.

One criterion is the number of speakers of the language. A second is the extent to which a language is geographically dispersed : in how many continents and countries is it used or its knowledge necessary? A third is its functional load : how extensive is the range of purposes for which it is used? In particular, to what extent is it the medium for highly valued cultural manifestations such as science or literature? A fourth is the economic and political influence of the native speakers of the language.

21. The author wants to evaluate the importance of the English language because it is
 (a) the language of the Britishers
 (b) studied as second language in India
 (c) the most important language of the world
 (d) used in many countries

22. The speakers of every language
 (a) consider their language as the most important
 (b) do not like other languages
 (c) treat all the languages alike
 (d) want to learn English
23. The writer's evaluation of the importance of the English language is based on
 (a) general notions
 (b) linguistic assumptions
 (c) subjective feelings
 (d) objective criteria

PASSAGE 8

The spectre of unemployment is looming large on almost every graduate with a general purpose degree. This education has very little relevance to life and therefore, the young generation is getting frustrated. If we look deeper into the problems of extremism and terrorism, perhaps unemployment and frustration of young people is one of the main reasons for this malaise. The most dangerous trend is the growing violence in the human heart. The first task of every university is to ensure that violence to each other does not become the new human culture. The sociologists have a lot to contribute by analysing the thought processes of the young persons and evolving the remedial measures.

24. The young generation is getting frustrated because
 (a) they have taken general purpose degrees
 (b) they remain unemployed
 (c) they are drawn to terrorism
 (d) there is violence around them
25. Enormous responsibility to comprehend the problems of young generation lies with
 (a) the press and TV media
 (b) our political leaders
 (c) the sociologists
 (d) education administrators
26. The increase in violence in our society is
 (a) a sign of revolutionary zeal
 (b) the result of modern system of education
 (c) the urge to surpass others in life
 (d) the result of frustration in life

PASSAGE 9

There is a natural tendency in every animate being to resent restrictions. If you block the growth of a plant, it will try to pierce through the blockade. If you enclose a worm or fish in a glass jar, you will find it restlessly moving hither and thither to find a way out. Similarly, if you confine a bird or an animal in a cage or a room, you will find it gets constantly trying to break through the cage or the room in a fit of escape.

Only when it gets tired or identifies itself with the environment of the prison, will it get silent. Thus, the urge to be free is inborn in all animate beings. It gets suppressed only on its identification with the situation. The urge to be free is also reason present in inanimate objects but it is latent and ultimately gets fulfilled. It is for the very reason that matter constantly changes its shape. The charge is in a way a fulfilment of that urge.

- 27.** The natural tendency among the living beings is to
- (a) submit to the circumstances
 - (b) strive for freedom
 - (c) place restrictions in the way of others
 - (d) create blockades
- 28.** A worm in a glass jar first tries to
- (a) adjust itself
 - (b) break the jar
 - (c) move out of it
 - (d) ignore the change
- 29.** An animal will sit quietly in a cage after it has
- (a) eaten well
 - (b) struggled enough
 - (c) identified itself with the changed circumstances
 - (d) given up hope of freedom
- 30.** Matter constantly changes its shape because it
- (a) is inanimate
 - (b) also has an urge to be free
 - (c) is moulded into different shapes by men
 - (d) has not soul

PASSAGE 10

At what age should school begin? The answer must depend upon home, its topography rather than upon its oral or psychological character. A child who lives on a farm in the countryside can happily and profitably spend his time wandering about, watching animals, reaping, threshing, etc until the time comes when it is necessary to begin formal instruction. But for the urban child whose parents live in a cramped apartment, it is quite otherwise. For him, school is desirable as an escape into freedom—freedom of movement, freedom of noise and freedom of companionship.

- 31.** Topography means the science of
- (a) drawing maps
 - (b) description of features of a place
 - (c) shooting photographs
 - (d) description of topics
- 32.** Formal instruction here implies
- (a) school discipline
 - (b) rigid code
 - (c) regular education at school
 - (d) disciplined conduct at school

- 33.** Here the author believes that

- (a) a child in a countryside need not have formal instruction
- (b) an urban child likes freedom of all kinds
- (c) a countryside child is benefitted by free environment all over
- (d) an urban child must begin formal instruction late

- 34.** The author thinks that the problem as to when the children should go to school depends rather on the

- (a) psychological character of home
- (b) moral character of home
- (c) topographical character of home
- (d) spiritual character of home

PASSAGE 11

If you want your mate to stop guessing about your feelings and motives, you have to be prepared to reveal yourself. And in order to reveal yourself, you have to know yourself profoundly. You can't talk openly and honestly with your mate until you have tried being honest with yourself first. Take time off to be alone. Use that time not simply to engage in passive meditation, but to carry on an active inner dialogue with yourself. Between the person you think you are and the inner you that operates at gut level. Communicating with yourself involves revelation, self-analysis and re-evaluation. Change is impossible otherwise. No architect in any field will attempt to make new plans without assessing the present situation. So too, each of us can and must make an assessment of our own assets or liabilities.

- 35.** Your mate shall stop guessing about your feelings when

- (a) you are honest
- (b) you know yourself
- (c) he reveals himself to you
- (d) you talk openly

- 36.** You can talk openly and honestly to your mate only when you

- (a) reveal your emotions and feelings
- (b) are honest with him
- (c) do not engage yourself in passive meditation
- (d) are honest with yourself

- 37.** You should take time off to be alone so that

- (a) you talk to yourself
- (b) you engage yourself in passive meditation
- (c) your motives and feelings are clear
- (d) you do not change yourself

- 38.** No architect plans without assessing the present situation because

- (a) each of us can and must make an assessment
- (b) self-analysis and re-evaluation are necessary factors for him
- (c) change is impossible otherwise
- (d) no assessment of our own assets or liabilities is possible

PASSAGE 12

There is a widely held but mistaken belief that meetings are for solving the problems and making the decisions. For a start, the number of people attending a meeting tends to be inversely proportional to their collective ability to reach conclusions and make decisions. And these are the least important elements. Instead hours are spent in side issues, playing elaborate games with one another.

- 39.** According to the author, meetings
- (a) are a waste of time
 - (b) help to solve problems
 - (c) are a form of playing elaborate games
 - (d) allow decisions to be made
- 40.** The words that show that many people believe meetings are important are
- (a) widely held
 - (b) collective ability
 - (c) number of people
 - (d) solving problems
- 41.** The author believes in the sanctity of holding meetings for
- (a) practical value
 - (b) transactional features
 - (c) collective opinion
 - (d) decision-making

PASSAGE 13

My duties in the zoo included feeding the lions. The popular belief is that lions have sweetness of character, sagacity and courage. But my experience with them shattered this so called myth. Albert, the male, often used to surprise me by suddenly jumping out against the bars with a hair-raising cough of wrath. When I leapt in the air like a startled stag, I am sure he enjoyed his little joke. Albert had a prodigious appetite and after hastily snatching the biggest joint of meat, he would pinch the meat belonging to the lioness and the cubs.

- 42.** The traditional image of a lion according to the passage is that
- (a) he is intelligent, kind and handsome
 - (b) he is foolish, short-tempered and dangerous
 - (c) he is wise, gentle and brave
 - (d) he is noisy, hungry and wrathful
- 43.** The sentence, "I leapt in the air like a startled stag" indicates that the writer was
- (a) extremely frightened
 - (b) very surprised
 - (c) quite shocked
 - (d) absolutely delighted
- 44.** The lion in this passage is described as if
- (a) he was an unusually cruel beast
 - (b) he had a personality like a human
 - (c) he was a beast with a sense of wrath
 - (d) he had a mind like a monster

PASSAGE 14

Attracted by the serenity of the evening, a friend and I lately went to one of the public walks just near by the city. Here, we sauntered together for sometime. Then my friend, stopping suddenly, caught me by the elbow and led me out of the public walk. I could perceive by the quickness of his pace and by his frequently looking behind, that he was attempting to avoid somebody who followed. We now turned to the right, then to the left, but completely in vain. The person whom he attempted to escape, gained upon us each moment. So, that at last we finally stood still, resolving to face what we could not avoid.

- 45.** The author's friend took him away from the public walk, as
- (a) the public place was dirty, crowded and noisy
 - (b) it was impossible to meet their friend
 - (c) he wanted to avoid a person following them
 - (d) the public was looking strangely at them
- 46.** The author concludes from his friend's quick pace and his frequent looking back
- (a) that he was running out of time
 - (b) that he was worried about reaching home early
 - (c) that he wanted to escape from a person following him
 - (d) that he was troubled inwardly
- 47.** His friend caught the author by the elbow
- (a) to check the author from falling down
 - (b) as the author was not in a position to walk on his own
 - (c) as he was panicked at the sudden appearance of a person he didn't like
 - (d) as he had stepped on a slippery thing

PASSAGE 15

American Indians believed that there were spirits everywhere in the nature that made grass and the plants to grow and the wind to blow. Every bird and animal had a spirit. To obtain some of this mystery power from nature and to secure the life-long protection of an individual spirit, every boy and every girl in some tribes spent a night or a few days and nights, alone in a solitary place believed to be especially strong in supernatural power. Usually, the longest vigil was four nights in the plains and five in the plateau, for these were mystic numbers. Fasting and thirsting, the child waited for a voice to speak to him.

- 48.** The ceremony of the solitary retreat was observed by
- (a) every boy and every girl in all the tribes
 - (b) every boy and every girl in some tribes
 - (c) only every girl in some of the tribes
 - (d) every girl in all the tribes and every boy in some of the tribes
- 49.** The purpose of the retreat was to
- (a) keep a vigil
 - (b) hear a voice
 - (c) observe a fast
 - (d) secure the aid of a spirit for oneself